

Dear Hiring Team,

Bitpanda's design system role caught my attention. A platform serving first-time investors and active traders across crypto, stocks, and commodities on web and native. That's a system with real surface area. Different user contexts, shared components underneath. Getting that to work consistently at scale is the kind of problem I find genuinely interesting.

I've built two production systems from scratch in the past four years. At Abacum I defined the token architecture and governance across squads for a fintech data platform, and built the full engineering pipeline alongside a dedicated engineer: Token Studio and Style Dictionary for token export, a GitHub submodule connected to an npm package, ESLint rules for adoption enforcement, Storybook in Chromatic for visual regression. At Remuner I did the same as the sole designer, this time applying a lesson from Abacum: start with a deliberately small token set. A minimal set is easier to govern and easier to scale than a comprehensive one that never gets adopted. In both cases, engineers consumed updates without needing to involve design.

What I find most interesting about this role is the advocacy side. Getting a design system used is a different problem from building one. At Abacum I put together the business case with the head of design, presented it to engineering leadership, and ran Maker Days to drive adoption across squads. That work sits between design and engineering in a way that requires knowing both sides well enough to be credible with each.

I'd be glad to walk you through the cases in more detail. The design systems case is at <https://manel-leiva.com/cases/design-systems>.

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